

Japan Supplier Evidence Check

WORKED SAMPLE REPORT

Public-source research
Checked September 27, 2026

SUPPLIER

Marujyu Oya

The Marujyu Soysauce & Seasoning Corp.

SCENARIO

Should a U.S. specialty-food importer contact this supplier?

OUTCOME

VERIFY FIRST

Executive answer. English-language sources alone justify contacting Marujyu Oya, and Japanese-source research does not overturn that. The MAFF export plan states that exports were routed through a domestic Japanese trading company, and identifies direct-export know-how, capacity and country-specific product requirements as issues to resolve.

01 ENGLISH BASELINE

WHAT AN ENGLISH-ONLY BUYER CAN CONFIRM

- Products: broth-enriched soy sauce (Aji Marujyu), brewed and reduced-salt soy sauce, miso
- Contact path: English contact form, email and phone
- Overseas sales network: USA, Hong Kong, Taiwan, Malaysia, UAE, Bahrain, Oman
- Halal certification from Japan Islamic Trust (JIT)

NOT ESTABLISHED IN ENGLISH

- Current U.S. buying route (direct or via trading company)
- MOQ and available capacity
- U.S.-specific formulations, labels or packs
- Current certification scope
- U.S. distributor or territory restrictions

02 JAPANESE-SOURCE FINDINGS

FINDING · EVIDENCE

WHY IT MATTERS

- 1** **FACT** The plan states that exports were routed through a domestic Japanese trading company and that the company aimed to expand direct trade with overseas trading companies. [MAFF export plan](#), Sales issue ①
Supports contact, but verify whether a U.S. importer can buy directly today or must go through a trading company.
- 2** **FACT** The plan's FY2021 export markets and FY2029 targets do not include the U.S., although the current English profile lists the USA. [MAFF plan](#), Section 4; [English profile](#)
Ask how the U.S. is served today and whether it is in scope for new export business.
- 3** **FACT** The plan lists expanding foodservice and OEM/ODM contract products as a sales action. [MAFF plan](#), Actions ①
Private-label or custom-product buyers have a concrete question to raise.
- 4** **FACT** The plan identifies issues: halal-line equipment upgrade, labor shortage, domestic products exported as-is, limited direct-export know-how. [MAFF plan](#), Issues
Current capacity, U.S. formulation and who handles export paperwork are unconfirmed.
- 5** **INFERENCE** Public sources cite different halal certifiers: company pages cite JIT; the plan cites Japan Halal Association (2014). [EN/JP halal pages](#); [MAFF plan](#)
Not an indication that any certificate is invalid. Confirm current issuer, site, products and scope.

BEFORE
CONTACT



AFTER JAPANESE SOURCES
VERIFY FIRST

The supplier still appears worth contacting. The Japanese research does not reverse that decision; it sharpens the first conversation and flags what to resolve before spending more time.

TOPIC	ENGLISH-ACCESSIBLE	JAPANESE SOURCE · MAFF PLAN UNLESS NOTED	COMMERCIAL RELEVANCE	SOURCE
Exports	Sales network: USA, HK, Taiwan, Malaysia, UAE, Bahrain, Oman	FACT FY2021 soy-sauce exports: Malaysia, UAE; exporting began after 2014 halal certification	Documented overseas activity, mainly halal markets	EN profile , MAFF plan
U.S. position	USA listed in sales network and online sales	FACT U.S. not named in FY2021 markets or FY2029 targets (Asia, Europe, Middle East)	Confirm how the U.S. is served today	EN profile , MAFF plan
Route & intent	NOT FOUND	FACT Exports were routed via a domestic trading company; stated aim to expand direct overseas trade	INFERENCE An importer with its own channel fits the stated partner type	MAFF plan
B2B / OEM / ODM	NOT FOUND	FACT Stated action: expand foodservice and OEM/ODM products	Private-label question worth raising	MAFF plan
Capacity	NOT FOUND	FACT Identified needs: halal-line equipment upgrade and expansion; labor shortage	Volume for a new buyer: NEEDS SUPPLIER CONFIRMATION	MAFF plan
Formulation, packs	Product descriptions only	FACT Domestic products were exported as-is; per-country additive work needed; packaging rules noted for EU only	U.S. versions and packs: NOT PUBLICLY CONFIRMED	MAFF plan
Export docs	NOT FOUND	FACT Direct-export document know-how was lacking; stated action: find trading companies for procedures	Clarify who prepares export paperwork	MAFF plan
Certification	Halal certification from JIT	FACT Obtained ISO 9001 (2000), ISO 22000 (2007), organic miso (1999), Japan Halal Association halal (2014)	INFERENCE Certifier references differ; confirm current scope	EN halal , JP halal , MAFF plan
Distributors	Main clients: mainly Japanese wholesalers, retailers	JP profile: same list; no U.S. distributor named	U.S. distributor or exclusivity: NOT PUBLICLY CONFIRMED	EN profile , JP profile

JAPANESE SOURCE EXCERPTS

現在、国内商社帳合による販売ルートで輸出しており、今後は現地販路を有する海外商社との直接取引を拡大させる必要がある

At plan time, exports ran via a domestic trading company; more direct trade with overseas trading companies was needed.

[MAFF export plan](#) · Sales issue ①

国内展開製品をそのまま輸出しているため、各国での添加物等の規制に対応した製品開発...が必要

At plan time, Japanese-market products were exported unchanged; per-country additive-rule development was needed.

[MAFF export plan](#) · Production issue ③

直接輸出の必要書類や手続きなどのノウハウが不足している

The plan states the company lacked know-how on the documents and procedures required for direct export.

[MAFF export plan](#) · Logistics issue ②

Source quality. All five sources are primary: company-official pages (EN and JP) and a company-submitted export plan published by MAFF. Confidence is **HIGH** that each source says what is cited. The MAFF plan states plans and issues (data FY2021–FY2029; PDF dated Feb 2026), not verified current operations.

FACT Directly supported by cited public material

INFERENCE Our interpretation of what the evidence means commercially

RECOMMENDED NEXT ACTION

VERIFY FIRST

Contacting the supplier appears reasonable. Resolve the items below in the first conversation, before committing significant sourcing time.

QUESTIONS TO ASK THE SUPPLIER

- 1 Can a U.S. importer buy directly, or must orders move through a Japanese trading company?
- 2 What are the current MOQ, case pack, lead time and Incoterms?
- 3 What production capacity is currently available for new export business?
- 4 Which SKUs, formulations, labels and package formats are available for the U.S.?
- 5 Please provide the current ISO and halal certificates, including issuer, site, product and scope.
- 6 Are there existing U.S. distributor or territory restrictions?
- 7 Is B2B / OEM / ODM production currently available to overseas customers?

KNOWN / UNKNOWN / VERIFY

KNOWN FROM PUBLIC SOURCES

- Company, products and contact path
- Overseas sales network, incl. USA
- Plan: exports routed via a Japanese trading company
- Plan: aim to expand direct overseas trade
- Plan: foodservice and OEM/ODM expansion

NOT PUBLICLY CONFIRMED

- Direct U.S. purchasing route
- MOQ, lead time, Incoterms
- Available capacity
- U.S. distributor or exclusivity

VERIFY DIRECTLY

- Current certificate issuer and scope
- U.S. formulations, labels and packs
- Who handles export paperwork
- Commercial terms

NO-GAP POLICY

We do not manufacture findings. If English-language evidence already answers the commercial question, the delivered result may be **NO MATERIAL GAP**: additional Japanese-source research found nothing that materially changes the next action. It is a valid, completed research result.

RESEARCH BOUNDARY

Public sources only. Not supplier approval, a factory audit, a credit check, legal advice, a food-safety review, certification verification or import-compliance advice. Public information may be incomplete or outdated.

Methodology: 1 Establish the English-accessible baseline · 2 Review relevant Japanese primary sources · 3 Compare material differences · 4 Separate fact from inference · 5 Identify unanswered commercial questions · 6 Link every material finding to evidence

Japan Supplier Evidence Check · Up to 3 named Japanese suppliers

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